

Storage and Sessions Differences with PWA Kit

PWA Kit manages auth on both client and server through `commerce-sdk-react`. Storefront Next handles auth exclusively on the server through middleware and stores tokens in `httpOnly` cookies that client-side JavaScript can't access.

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Key Differences

Aspect	PWA Kit	Storefront Next
Auth management	<code>commerce-sdk-react</code> Auth class	Server middleware
Access token	<code>localStorage</code> (<code>access_token_{siteId}</code>)	Cookie <code>at_{siteId}</code>
Other session data	<code>localStorage</code>	Cookie
Server-side storage	In-memory (<code>MemoryStorage</code>)	Request cookie (stateless)
Auth calls	Client and server (via <code>commerce-sdk-react</code>)	Server (via middleware and SDK on clients)
Token refresh	SDK refreshes on both client and server when token is expired	Middleware refreshes server token on route handler

Auth Flow

In PWA Kit, auth runs on both server and client. During SSR, `commerce-sdk-react` uses in-memory storage because browser APIs aren't available. On the client, the SDK initiates the SLAS OAuth flow (guest login) and stores tokens in `localStorage` and cookies.

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For details, see [Storage and Sessions](#).

Accessing Auth Data in Components

PWA Kit exposes auth state through `commerce-sdk-react` hooks:

```
1 import { useCustomerType, useCustomerId } from '@salesforce/commerce-sdk-react';
2
3 const { isGuest, isRegistered } = useCustomerType();
4 const customerId = useCustomerId();
```

Storefront Next exposes a subset of session data through the `useAuth()` hook:

```
1 import { useAuth } from '@salesforce/storefront-next';
2
3 const session = useAuth();
4 // session.userType, session.customerId, session.sessionId
```

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